

ASCII Data in Text Archive Files

When a table that contains only ASCII characters is exported to a [text archive file](#), the .idt file adheres to the basic [archive file format](#). If the table contains non-ASCII information, the format of the archive file is extended to include code page information.

Text archive files that contain only ASCII characters

When a table that contains only ASCII characters is exported to an archive file, the .idt file is in the basic [archive file format](#). Each stream in the table is exported as a file with an .ibd file name extension. The .ibd files are stored in a folder with the same name as the table. For example, consider the export of the following [Binary](#) table.

 Expand table

Name	Data
Books	Books.ibd
Cars	Cars.ibd

The directory structure after exporting this table is as follows. The information in the database table is exported to Binary.idt. The two streams of binary data are exported to Book.ibd and Cars.ibd saved in the folder named Binary.

syntax

```
Binary.idt
[Binary]
  Books.ibd
  Cars.ibd
```

The Binary.idt archive file is in the basic [archive file format](#) and would look as follows.

syntax

```
Name Data
s72 v0
Binary Name
Books Books.ibd
Cars Cars.ibd
```

Text archive files that contain non- ASCII characters

If the file contains non-ASCII data, the basic [archive file format](#) of the .idt file is extended to include code page information. The third row in the .idt table is the numeric code page followed by the table name and primary key column names separated by tabs.

📌 Note

An .idt file that contains non-ASCII information should be saved in the ASCII format. For example, a text archive file can contain the column and table names encoded as UTF-8, but the archive file itself should be ASCII.

The following ActionText table localized into French would contain non-ASCII information. The numeric code page used for French strings is 1252.

 Expand table

Action	Description	Template
ADVERTISE	Publication d'informations sur l'application	

The exported archive file, ActionText.idt, would be as follows.

```
syntax
Action Description Template
s72 L0 L0
1252 ActionText Action
Advertise Publication d'informations sur l'application
```

Note

If a text archive file contains non-ASCII data, the archive file includes code page information. Archive files with code page information can only be imported back into a database of that exact code page or into a language neutral database. In the case of a language neutral database, the code page is set to the code page of the archive file. For more information about how Windows Installer handles code pages see the section [Code Page Handling \(Windows Installer\)](#).

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